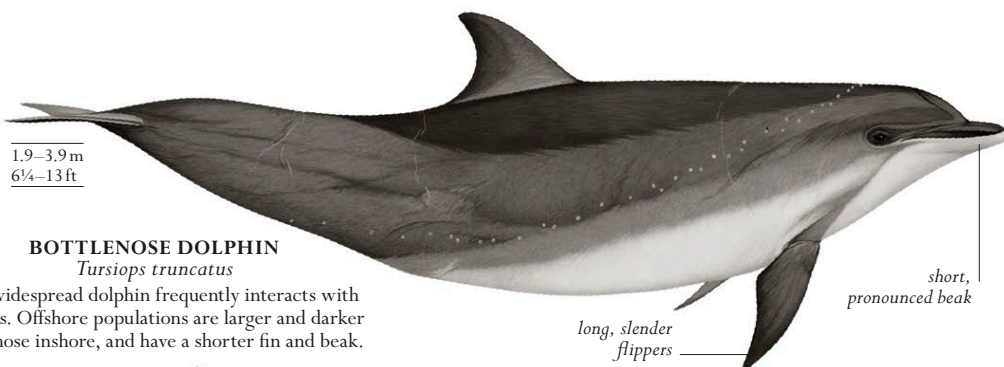




ROUGH-TOOTHED DOLPHIN
Steno bredanensis

Occurring in most warm waters, this species has a conical head that extends into a long, slender beak, and a broad-based, pointed dorsal fin.

2.6–2.8 m
8½–9¼ ft



BOTTLENOSE DOLPHIN
Tursiops truncatus

This widespread dolphin frequently interacts with humans. Offshore populations are larger and darker than those inshore, and have a shorter fin and beak.

1.9–3.9 m
6¼–13 ft

long, slender
flippers

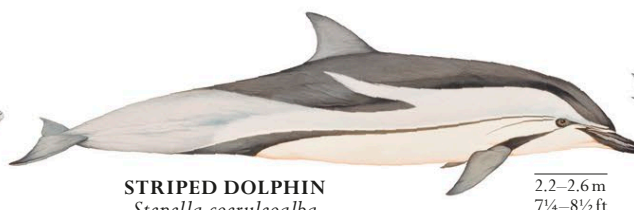
short,
pronounced beak



ATLANTIC SPOTTED DOLPHIN
Stenella frontalis

From the tropical and subtropical Atlantic, this dolphin has dark spots below and pale spots above. These increase in density as it matures.

1.9–2.3 m
6¼–7½ ft



STRIPED DOLPHIN
Stenella coeruleoalba

Found in temperate and tropical parts of all oceans, this acrobatic species has a distinctive pattern of blue stripes and wedges.

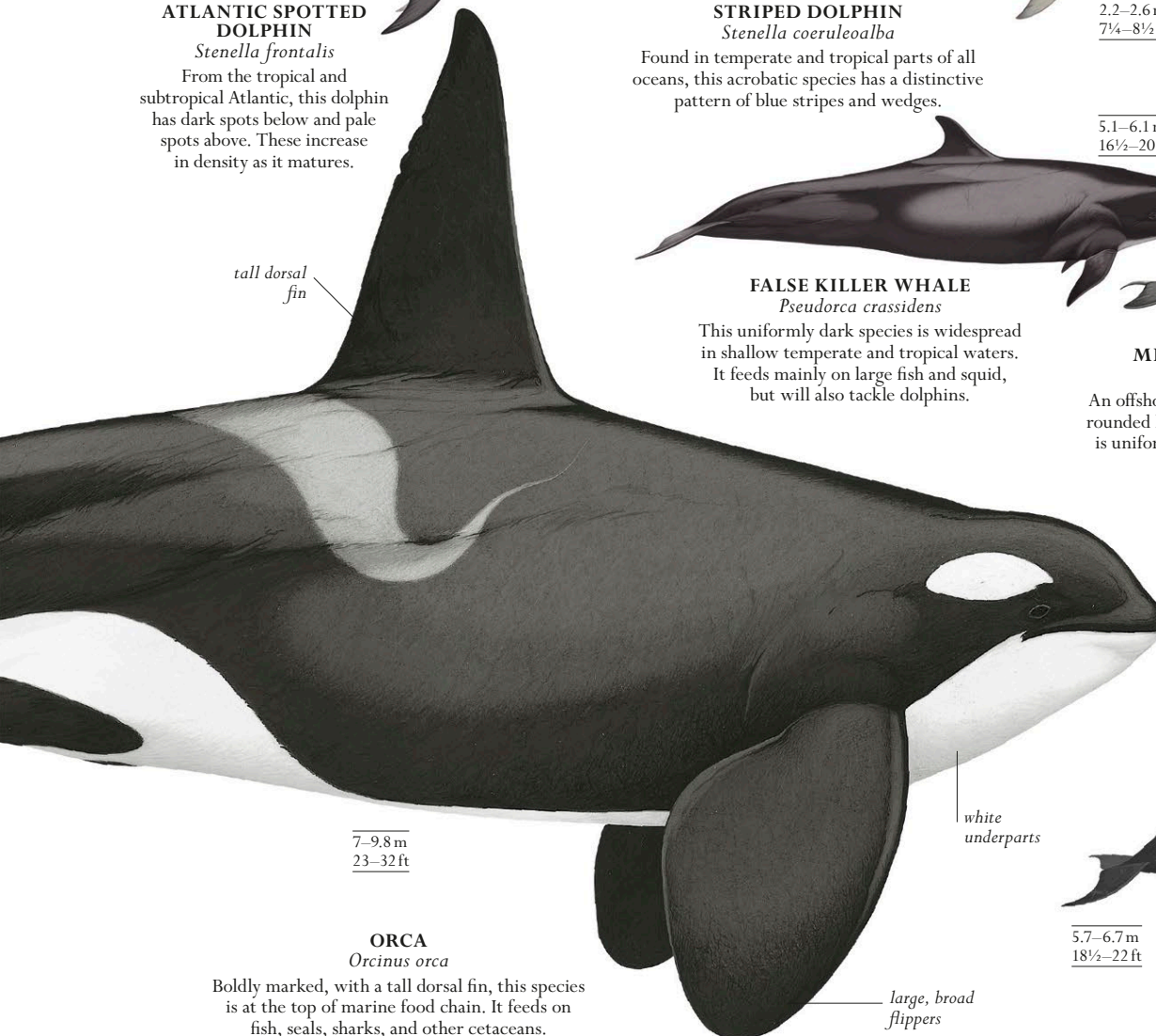
2.2–2.6 m
7¼–8½ ft



SOUTHERN RIGHT WHALE DOLPHIN
Lissodelphis peronii

Within its range, the only dolphin to lack a dorsal fin, this distinctive black and white species occurs throughout the cool oceans of the southern hemisphere.

3 m
10 ft

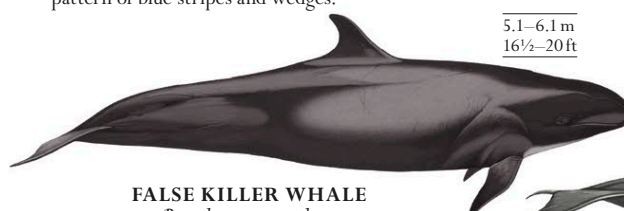


tall dorsal
fin

7–9.8 m
23–32 ft

ORCA
Orcinus orca

Boldly marked, with a tall dorsal fin, this species is at the top of marine food chain. It feeds on fish, seals, sharks, and other cetaceans.



FALSE KILLER WHALE
Pseudorca crassidens

This uniformly dark species is widespread in shallow temperate and tropical waters. It feeds mainly on large fish and squid, but will also tackle dolphins.

5.1–6.1 m
16½–20 ft



MELON-HEADED WHALE
Peponocephala electra

An offshore tropical species, this whale has a rounded head and a tall, pointed dorsal fin. It is uniformly grey, with a darker face mask.

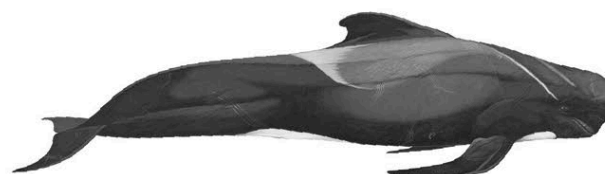
2.8 m
9¼ ft



PYGMY KILLER WHALE
Feresa attenuata

Lacking a beak, this small, dark, robust species can be very aggressive. It kills and eats other dolphins within its circumtropical range.

2.1–2.6 m
7–8½ ft



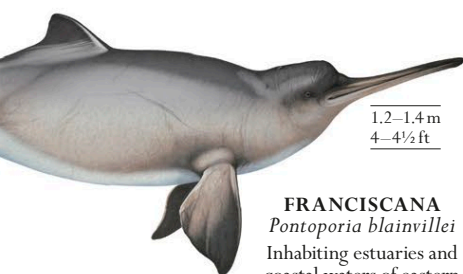
LONG-FINNED PILOT WHALE
Globicephala melas

Prone to mass stranding, this sociable species is widespread in temperate waters. Its bulbous forehead can be seen as it lifts its head out of the water to look around.

5.7–6.7 m
18½–22 ft

white
underparts

large, broad
flippers



FRANCISCANA
Pontoporia blainvillei
Inhabiting estuaries and coastal waters of eastern S. America, this species has, proportionally, the longest beak of any cetacean at 15 per cent of its total body length.

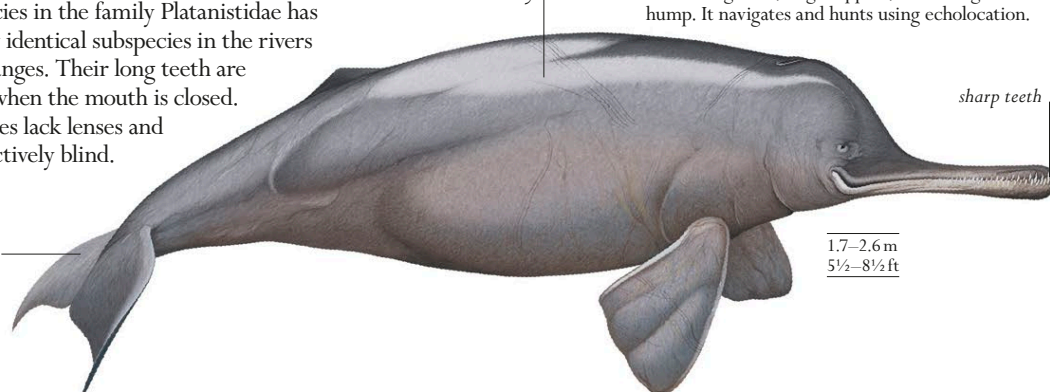
1.2–1.4 m
4–4½ ft

SOUTH ASIAN RIVER DOLPHIN

The sole species in the family Platanistidae has two virtually identical subspecies in the rivers Indus and Ganges. Their long teeth are visible even when the mouth is closed. Their tiny eyes lack lenses and they are effectively blind.

proportionally
broad flukes

robust, uniformly
coloured body



sharp teeth

1.7–2.6 m
5½–8½ ft

SOUTH ASIAN RIVER DOLPHIN
Platanista gangetica

From grey to pale blue to brown, this dolphin has a distinctive long beak, large flippers, and triangular dorsal hump. It navigates and hunts using echolocation.